Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Al Baster

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Al Baster

Sculptor & Public-Art Star

Al considers a pedestal a sculpture that has given up on itself. Al makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane.

• **Frank Lloyd Wrong** designed the entrance around Al's sculpture. They still disagree about which one visitors came to see.

• Competes with **Vincent Van Faux** for commissions. Al keeps calculating how many paintings weigh as much as one sculpture.

• **Dada DiCapo** once performed inside one of Al's sculptures. Al found out from the photographs.

ACTING TIPS

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Al Baster. I made the entrance sculpture. I would appreciate your admiration in a tone that suggests prompt payment.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Al Baster

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Caring for an aging parent makes unpaid work a threat to home life, not just professional pride.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Al Baster

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Find the frame that always contains a portrait of you; check its top.*

2 *A wall-hung painting has a backstage area. That is where to investigate.*

3 *A blue cushion has been acting as a very quiet accomplice. Check its reverse.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Al Baster

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Cold-cast resin with metal powder. That's the piece. Publicity said solid bronze; I let it stand too long. Grant wanted the same size, a lower price, and his name bigger. My last installment was due. I've got somebody at home who needs help getting up the stairs. A donor congratulating me on the honor of a commission doesn't pay the person staying with them tonight.

IF MURDERER

> Cold-cast resin with metal powder. Publicity said solid bronze; I let it stand. Grant could expose the difference, cut my final payment, and make his name bigger than mine. I've got somebody at home who needs help getting up the stairs. He enjoyed discussing how grateful I ought to be for a commission while he held the money I needed from it.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Al Baster

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I refused a replacement and crossed out solid bronze. Frank shut the alcove while I argued over credit. Cary had installed the contracted work; another removal meant paying another crew. I said reopen with the true label or explain the closed door. I said it badly. Cary, you've heard worse from me. I wish that excused anything.

IF MURDERER

I refused a replacement and crossed out solid bronze. Frank closed the alcove; Cary had already installed the contracted piece. After the bottle preview I went looking for Grant about my last payment. His private glass was set out. I sat beside it. Nobody came, so I left. I wasn't paying another crew to make him a second sculpture for free. Cary, you can move a heavy thing out of somebody's way. I couldn't move that man.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Al Baster

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Gold leaf over resin with metal powder. The sample is on the job card. I let publicity say solid bronze, and I kept saying it too. Cary, leave it where it is. Are we allowed to call home yet? Someone needs to know why I'm still here.

IF MURDERER

> The scrap in his glass is leaf from my sculpture. I cut that red-faced, silver-backed material myself. It gets everywhere during a job. It isn't bottle paper. I corrected the sculpture label. I've answered that. Now will someone tell me when I can call home?

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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BALLOT

Al Baster

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Al Baster

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The contract bought resin, and the corrected label says resin. My sample is gold leaf; the glass scrap is foil-backed red paper. The reduced settlement cost me. Cary, thanks for not pretending it was bronze while you moved it. I owe an explanation for letting that description stand. First I want to call home. Someone there has been waiting all evening for me.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The fragment was foil-backed paper, not my accent leaf. The sample card made my material story untenable. I had opened the loan bottle during the preview and later used its poison in his glass. I pointed you toward sculpture debris because I didn't want that scrap considered with the damaged closure. It wasn't a unique match, but it wasn't my finish either. Grant could make the publicity fraud the whole story of my work. Somebody at home will be waiting for me. I kept telling myself what they needed justified what I did. They never asked me to bring this into their life.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.